Audit of TGA's COVID-19 Vaccine Safety Monitoring Plan (2021–2026) – ISO 19011 documentation-compliance audit - Independent Audit Process

Framework: ISO 19011:2018 + ANAO Performance Audit Standards + OSINT Methodology | Period: Feb 2022–Oct 2026 | Finding: NON-CONFORMING

1. FOI REQUESTS → 2. OAIC REVIEWS → 3.RESEARCH AND ANALYSIS → 4. EXPERT COLLABORATION → 5. LEGAL ANALYSIS → 6. AUDIT & MONITORING

KEY AUDIT STEPS*

- Risk Assessment: 68.4M doses (91% rollout), provisional approval, expert warnings (Phillips 2021)
- Define Criteria: TGA Plan (17 outputs + 2 governance assessments across 5 distinct plan objectives),
- ISO 19011, ICH E2E, TGA's own GMP/GCP standards
- Evidence Collection: FOI Act 1982: Department sample searches (TRIM, Promap); 2,218+ page sample estimate
- OAIC Reviews: MR22/00538, FOI 25-0166
- Senate Estimates: 9 Oct 2025
- Public Docs: 150+ safety reports
- Analysis: Compare 19 assessed outputs (17 strategies
- + 2 governance) vs documented evidence
- Classify: Full/Partial/Not documented
- Findings: 7 major non-conformities
- 16% fully documented, 84% partial/none
- Reporting: GitHub + Zenodo DOI (permanent archive)
- Monitoring: Parliamentary oversight (Senate Estimates)
- OAIC reviews ongoing
- OSINT Research Methodology:
- ISO 19011 framework - Systematic collection & verification: 150+ TGA reports, FOI/OAIC releases,
- Senate Hansard, performance data
- Cross-reference multiple sources to identify contradictions in TGA positions
- Transparent documentation: GitHub version control + Zenodo DOI + blockchain permanent archive

ISO 19011 PRINCIPLES APPLIED

1. Integrity: Independent, no conflicts of interest, ~30 yrs experience
2. Fair Presentation: Evidence-based findings, limitations acknowledged
3. Due Professional Care: 4-year systematic investigation, limitations acknowledged.
4. Confidentiality: FOI framework respected, sensitive info protected
5. Independence: No funding from manufacturers/government/advocacy
6. Evidence-Based: 4-tier hierarchy, verifiable primary sources
7. Risk-Based: High-consequence gaps, materiality focus (68.4M doses)

ANAO STANDARDS APPLIED

- Proper Use of Resources: Assess effectiveness, economy, efficiency, ethics
- Evidence-Based Approach: FOI releases, OAIC reviews, Senate testimony
- Parliamentary Importance: National health emergency, largest provisional rollout
- Risk Assessment: Materiality (68.4M doses), expert warnings, auditability
- Records Management: ANAO guidance applied to assess TGA documentation
- Performance Audit Process: Planning → Fieldwork → Reporting → Monitoring

7 MAJOR NON-CONFORMITIES

1. No Systematic Tracking: TGA described monitoring as 'day-to-day processes' never tracked against the Plan
2. No Coordination Protocols: none located linking AusVaxSafety and AEMS
3. Data Linkage Gap Persists: Expert warnings (2020) → same gaps exist (2025)
4. Contradictory FOI Positions: 'Don't exist' → 'Ample documents' → 'Subjective interpretation'
5. No Signal Pathways: 6.8M surveys → 150 signals → 57 actions (no documented bridge)
6. Communication Contradiction: 'No different' (public) vs 'Enhanced' (policy)
7. Expert Warnings Not Systematically Addressed: identified 2020-21, no documented corrective action located

EVIDENCE HIERARCHY

✓ Tier 1: FOI decisions, OAIC submissions, direct TGA communications (primary statutory)
✓ Tier 2: Senate testimony, QON 559 (primary documentary)
✓ Tier 3: Secondary documentary (partner reports, surveillance data)
✓ Tier 4: Tertiary contextual (international guidance)

Independent sources:

✓ OAIC reviews (MR22/00538, MR25/01153)
✓ External legal analysis
✓ Peer-reviewed publication

OUTCOME: NON-CONFORMING

16% outputs fully documented (3/19)
68% partial (13/19)
16% not documented (3/19)

Phases of Audit: 1. Plan the audit 2. Gather evidence 3. Assess conformity 4. Report & archive

*Scope: documentary evidence only (FOI, OAIC, Senate, public docs); no internal system access or interviews